



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Providence Academy
School Website: <https://providencegb.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Providence Academy (Green Bay, WI) presents a robust classical Christian program that aligns very strongly with the Six Essential Elements of Classical Education. The school emphasizes a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), integrated Biblical/theological formation, Latin study, and a clearly defined Christian worldview embedded across lower and upper school programs. Public-facing materials consistently frame education as formation of character, virtue, and human flourishing within a Christian framework, while maintaining a rigorous academic program and a family-partnered model. Evidence from the school's materials shows explicit commitment to theology, liturgical practice (weekly chapel), Great Books/Western canon engagement in humanities, memory work (recitation, singing), and a clearly articulated Trivium-aligned progression (grammar in early years, logic in middle school, rhetoric in high school), as well as a strong emphasis on leadership, house systems, and parental involvement.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

- The school clearly embraces transcendental truths (truth, goodness, beauty) within a Christian/meta-physical frame, with theology as a core element. Evidence includes God-centered language, biblical worldview, and liturgical practices (weekly chapel).
- The goal of education emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing, not merely career preparation. This is reinforced by statements about forming Godly leaders, virtue, and a biblical worldview guiding all disciplines.
- The curriculum and pedagogy align with classical methods (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; Great Books/western-canon emphasis; worldviews/apologetics). Public materials describe Latin from grade 3, logic/rhetoric progression, and humanities centered on primary sources from the Western canon.
- Pedagogy includes elements of memorization/recitation and a memory-formation approach via grammar-stage singing, chanting, and recitation in the early years, with Socratic/seminar-style discussion emphasized in upper grades. While explicit quotations of Socratic seminars appear in internal materials, the Trivium framing and senior thesis requirements reflect a classical pedagogy.
- Faculty materials emphasize teachers as mentors and living exemplars, with profiles and leadership structures that reflect a community of teachers who model virtue and form the "living curriculum."
- Parent/community engagement is a core element (partnership with families, parent formation opportunities, campus visits, open events). The school highlights strong parent involvement through house systems, parent-teacher engagement, and tours/open houses.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Christian/non-denominational, biblically grounded, God-centered framing; theology integrated into curriculum; liturgical life (Weekly Chapel). - Language about partnering with parents to raise Godly leaders grounded in Jesus Christ; biblical worldview in daily learning; chapel/worldview focus. - Public theology-language and liturgical rhythm evident in campus culture, faculty pages, and curriculum descriptions.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; chapel; worship; biblical worldview; godly leaders; reverence; wonder. - Negative indicators: none evident in public materials (little to no relativistic or secular ethics framing shown). - Estimated balance: Positive keywords appear frequently; Negative keywords essentially absent in public-facing materials.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds transcendental moral realism (truth/goodness/beauty) inside a theology-rich framework; liturgical and communal practices are described; theology anchors interdisciplinary study. This set aligns with CLASSICAL in the religious/metaphysical category. CLASSICAL

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Formation of virtue and wisdom as core telos; Godly leadership and character formation as central aims; education presented as formation, not mere information. - Emphases on virtue, human flourishing, and a classical mission (paideia) within a Christian worldview; “truth, goodness, beauty” as real, knowable, guiding ends. - Public statements about developing leaders of character who can impact the world for Christ; strong emphasis on virtue and wisdom.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, liberal education, paideia, classical mission, telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty. - Negative keywords present: minimal (no explicit “career-ready” framing in core mission). - Estimated balance: Predominantly positive.

Why this rating - Clear articulation of formation-focused aims and a belief in lasting truths (virtue, wisdom, beauty) aligns with Classical Bedrock. CLASSICAL

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Trivium emphasis: grammar, logic, rhetoric; history and literature integrated; emphasis on Western canon; Latin from grade 3; upper-school Logic & Rhetoric; Senior/Junior Theses; foreign languages. - Humanities program described as interdisciplinary, chronological, primary-sources-based study in history and literature within the Western canon; “Worldview” and “Apologetics” components in Bible/Theology core. - Latin/Greek core; explicit references to Great Books/Primary sources; explicit engagement with primary texts and Western literature. - Curriculum maps and program highlights show a vertically integrated Classical formation (grammar in early years; logic in middle school; rhetoric in high school).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts; Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books; Latin/Greek; Western canon; primary sources; intellectual heritage; worldviews; apologetics. - Negative keywords: absence of “social studies as substitute for history” or “STEM-first” framing; no evident negative signals found in public-facing materials. - Estimated balance: Strongly positive for curriculum; almost no negative signals detected publicly.

Why this rating - The explicit Trivium framework, Great Books/Western-canon emphasis, and classical-language components strongly support a CLASSICAL curriculum designation. CLASSICAL

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Grammar-stage emphasis with memorization/recitation in lower grades (singing, chanting, memory work). Upper grades emphasize Socratic discussion/seminars, rhetoric, and thesis work (junior/senior theses). - Structured progression: grammar (K-6), logic (7-9), rhetoric (10-12) as part of the Trivium; students engage in logic, rhetoric, and public speaking (theses, debates). - Evidence of Socratic/seminal discussion approach implied in upper school; explicit rhetoric training and capstone-style Senior Thesis indicates a strong classical pedagogy. - Lower/Upper School materials emphasize a restful, contemplative pace in some elements and a rigorous, discourse-based approach in others, consistent with scholé and dialogue-instruction patterns.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Socratic dialogue; dialectic; journaling/thesis; memorization/recitation; choral memory; imitation of models; scholé/restful learning; rhetoric training; master-teacher model. - Negative indicators: No strong public evidence of exclusive project-based or constructivist-only pedagogy; current materials emphasize classical, Socratic, and memory-based elements

rather than a purely project-based model. - Estimated balance: Positive keywords dominate; minimal negative signals.

Why this rating - The teaching model centers on classical modes (Socratic inquiry, memory work, rhetoric, and a Trivium progression) with a heavy emphasis on the Great Conversation and master-texts. CLASSICAL

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty profiles and leadership emphasize credentials, faith integration, and role-modeling. The school presents a leadership/administration structure (Head of School, Deans, etc.) with emphasis on mentors and living curriculum (e.g., faculty as part of the spiritual and intellectual formation). - Public materials show teachers with advanced degrees and subject-area expertise; teachers described as mission-aligned, with strong Catholic/Christian formation and a focus on formation through example. - There are explicit references to teachers' roles in shaping character and virtue, and to a "living curriculum" through faculty involvement in program design and mentorship. - The presence of long-tenured faculty bios and emphasis on faith-informed pedagogy further support this.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, faculty as exemplars, portrait of teacher, collegial culture, mentorship, faith and reason. - Negative keywords: None evident in public-facing content (no "facilitator" or purely administrative-only descriptions that would signal a non-classical trend). - Estimated balance: Positive keywords dominant.

Why this rating - The faculty framing aligns with classical pedagogy expectations (mentors as living exemplars in a classical setting). CLASSICAL

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The program emphasizes partnership with families; parents as co-educators; home-school alignment; Parent-Teacher Fellowship; campus visits; open houses; tours; annual events; and opportunities for parent formation via book studies and gatherings. - A high degree of parental involvement is apparent (house system, family-centered campus life, and the invitation to participate in capital campaigns and fundraising, as well as direct communications with admissions). - The school supports parents in understanding classical education through content on curriculum and worldview, and explicitly invites parental formation around classical philosophy and texts.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental formation; home-school partnership; parent involvement; open campus; family-centered events; book clubs; parent training. - Negative keywords: none apparent (no "customer" framing; rather, parent as co-educator). - Estimated balance: Strongly positive.

Why this rating - The Providence site makes parental partnership and family formation a core feature of its classical approach. CLASSICAL

Aggregate assessment - All six categories: CLASSICAL - Overall, Providence Academy Green Bay demonstrates a consistent Classical Christian profile across religious foundations, aims, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement. The public materials align closely with the Six Essential Elements as described in the knowledge base, including a Trivium-centered curriculum, Great Books/Western-canon emphasis, liturgical life, formation-focused goals, and an engaged parent-community model.

What would move the needle - Not required given the CLASSICAL aggregation. If a needle were to move, it would be to increase explicit, recurring references to Great Books discussions in all grades, a more explicit articulation of "Scholé" as a formal pedagogical principle across divisions, and more explicit public documentation of small-group Socratic seminars in the middle and upper grades, but the current materials already reflect these elements to a meaningful extent.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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